

Working with Files

PHP has inbuilt functions for working with files. Here are some basic commands needed to get you started with file handling. File handling is an integral part of PHP: it allows the programmer to manipulate an existing file for either reading, or modification. PHP scripts are frequently used to work with data stored in separate files, be they documents or spreadsheets, and the following commands allow programmers to manipulate files that contain data pertinent to the very purpose of writing the programming script in the first place.

fopen(): This function is used to open files in PHP. There will be two parameters inside the parentheses, the first being the name of the file to be opened, and the second parameter specifying the mode in which it should be opened. If **fopen()** is unable to open the file, a zero, indicating false, is returned.

fclose(): the exact reverse of **fopen()**, used to close files opened with **fopen()**.

fgetc(): This command is used to read a single specified character from a file. Note that the pointer has to be moved to the next character once a match is found. This command can also be used to read the contents of a file, character by character, as we've done in the example below. By far one of the most important file handling commands.

feof(): Used when a particular condition is to be checked until the end of the file is reached. This command will return a "true" when the end of a file is reached.

An example:

```
<?php
    $f=fopen("to_our_readers.txt","r") or
    exit("Unable to open file!");
    // Using while statement to search till the
```